Chapter 8: Architecture Governance

Study Guide, based on Mastering the TOGAF Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 8 (pp. 189-227)

Overview

Chapter 8 (pp. 189-227) covers how architecture is controlled and steered. At its core, architecture governance turns an organization's architectural needs into "a coherent set of policies, processes, procedures, and standards" (p. 189). Section 8.1 presents the Standard's Architecture Governance Framework, led by a CIO/CTO with development, implementation, and deployment capabilities that all use the Architecture Repository (pp. 190-193). Section 8.2 gives Jager's **ten steps for implementing governance** (pp. 193-204). Section 8.3 is about the **Architecture Board**: what it really is, CEO vs. CIO/CTO leadership, when to set one up, its responsibilities, its composition and size, and **ten steps to set it up** (pp. 204-224). Section 8.4 summarizes (pp. 224-227). Leave with this idea: an Architecture Board is a *board-level*, strategic body, not a meeting of IT architects. Without top-level sponsorship, architecture work has "little or no point" (pp. 205, 210). Chapter 8 is part of the GREEN reading tour (p. 189).

> **Reading note:** The Governance Framework (Figure 8-1), the Architecture Board definition, and its key responsibilities come from the Standard. The two ten-step lists are Jager's practical approach. His opinions include: add the **CEO** to the framework (pp. 193, 206), the CIO belongs on the business side (p. 192), boards made up only of C-level members are too strategic (p. 214), and his healthcare-regulator story (pp. 219-220).

Detailed Section Breakdown

Chapter Opener (p. 189)

- Governance is "the leadership compass" and backbone of the organization. The Architecture Governance Framework lines the organization's vision and standards up with real business demands (p. 189).

8.1 Managing the Architecture (pp. 190-193)

- **Grounded in daily business.** Governance is a shared responsibility of business leaders, not only the CIO/CTO. It reduces costs and risks and speeds up decisions and delivery (p. 190).
- **Purpose per TOGAF.** To control and manage the architecture and the Architecture Capability, the "executive body behind the architecture" (p. 190).
- **The framework is a starting point.** It shows a "possible structure" and should be adapted (p. 190).

Element of the Governance Framework (Figure 8-1)	Role	Page
CIO/CTO	Overall direction. Directly manages the Architecture Board and three capabilities	p. 191
Development capability	Chief Architect, Enterprise Architect, Segment Architect (formerly Domain Architect) (Ch. 10.2)	p. 191
Implementation capability	PMO, external vendors, implementation projects	p. 192
Deployment capability	Service management and operational systems that the architecture must fit into	p. 192

Element of the Governance Framework (Figure 8-1)	Role	Page
Architecture Repository	Used by all capabilities and continuously updated	p. 192

Jager's commentary (author's view): Information ownership lies with the business, so the CIO should sit on the business side, yet "nine out of ten" organizations (and the Standard) place the CIO in IT. The framework should add the **CEO** role (pp. 192-193).

8.2 Implementing Architecture Governance (pp. 193-204)

- Phase G (Implementation Governance) puts this approach into practice (p. 193).

Step	What it involves	Page
1. Establish the Architecture Governance Framework	Stakeholder kick-off workshops; a Governance Charter (scope, objectives, principles, what is governed, what success looks like); choose components; set up the board; formalize processes and decision criteria	pp. 194-195
2. Define governance roles and responsibilities	Role-definition workshop; role descriptions; map responsibilities in a RACI matrix	pp. 195-197
3. Develop governance policies and standards	Policy-drafting group; high-level policies broken into standards; stakeholder review; publish and train	p. 198
4. Set up an architecture compliance process	Domain compliance checklists; checkpoints in the project lifecycle; compliance reviews; exception handling with rationale and mitigation	pp. 198-199
5. Implement an architecture review process	Review templates (context, principle compliance, risks, solutions); scheduled reviews; preparation; documented decisions	pp. 199-200
6. Establish KPIs	e.g., % of compliant projects, number of reviews, number of exceptions, time to resolve issues; baselines, targets, dashboards	pp. 200-201
7. Integrate governance into the ADM	Checkpoints per phase (e.g., Preliminary: framework in place; B: alignment with goals); no progress without board sign-off	pp. 201-202
8. Develop a Communications Plan	Identify audiences; tailor materials; workshops and webinars (Ch. 14.3.3)	p. 202
9. Automate governance processes	Governance or EA tool; automated alerts and KPI reports (Ch. 7.7.1)	pp. 202-203
10. Ensure continuous improvement	Quarterly reviews; gather feedback; adjust and communicate the framework	p. 203

- **RACI (Tables 8-1, 8-2).** Responsible = carries out the activity. Accountable = ultimately answerable, and the responsible person reports to them. Consulted = gives input (stakeholder or expert). Informed = receives the output or needs to stay informed. In the example, for "Establish the Architecture Governance Framework" the Architect is Accountable, the Business Leader Responsible, and the Project Manager Consulted (p. 197).

8.3 Architecture Board (pp. 204-224)

- **What it does.** Oversees compliance, facilitates decisions, manages architecture risk, and reviews and approves deliverables. It manages architecture roles *functionally*, not hierarchically (p. 204).
- **"Board" means boardroom.** It is not a group of architects discussing content. The issues are strategic, so it is formed by senior management: C-level, key stakeholders, domain experts (p. 205).
- **Standard's definition.** "A cross-organization entity, which oversees the implementation of the strategy", representative of all key stakeholders and typically executives (p. 205).
- **The common failure.** In "nine out of ten cases" the board is formed by IT architects. Strategic decisions are then made elsewhere, leaving the Architecture Capability "in a perpetual state of

reactive action" and "structurally behind the times" (pp. 205-206).

8.3.1 Diverse Leadership (pp. 206-209)

Scenario	Scope of architecture work when new legislation hits	Page
1. CEO leadership	Broad, cross-domain: organizational model, roles, processes and the function model, information flows, aligned application landscape	pp. 206-207
2. CIO/CTO leadership	Narrow: CIO only information delivery, CTO only the technical side. A small part of the EA	p. 207

- **Figure 8-3.** The CEO directs both the CIO/CTO and the Architecture Board. The CIO/CTO manages unit managers, who manage the teams (p. 208).
- **Not just for large organizations.** Smaller and flatter organizations benefit too. The sponsor need not be the CEO, but attention must come from the highest levels (p. 209).

8.3.2 When to Set Up an Architecture Board (pp. 209-210)

- **Typical triggers:** a new CIO/CTO; mergers or acquisitions; restructuring (business change or rapid growth); recognition that strategy is not being implemented, or is implemented poorly (p. 209).
- **A sponsor is not enough.** A board is needed for organization-wide support. The board is the architecture's primary sponsor and itself needs a top-level sponsor, ideally the CEO. The company's board of directors is an often-overlooked resource (p. 210).
- Involvement should span planning through maintenance. Establish sponsorship *before* work begins (p. 210).

Jager's commentary (author's view): In nine out of ten cases, failed architecture efforts are due to "a significant lack of involvement and encouragement from senior management" (p. 210).

8.3.3 Key Responsibilities (pp. 211-213)

Category	Responsibilities	Page
Strategic	Provide a solid basis for decision-making; ensure continued flexibility (meet changing needs and exploit new technology while enforcing compliance); improve architecture maturity (never let it drop)	p. 211
Operational	Ensure consistent management and implementation (fixed membership, staggered terms); provide advice and guidance tested against the existing architecture	p. 212
Governance	Provide a process for accepting and approving architecture work; implement a control mechanism (usually in Phase G); recognize divergence from the architecture (Phase H)	pp. 212-213

- Roles and responsibilities should be formally approved by the lead sponsor, ideally the CEO (p. 213).

8.3.4 Composition and Size (pp. 213-215)

- **Size.** Four or five standing members, never more than ten. Membership can rotate, with staggered fixed terms for continuity (pp. 213-214).
- **Stakeholder representation.** Each member can represent assigned stakeholders and gather their input (p. 213).
- **Mix of levels.** Not exclusively C-level. Lower-level managers and experts join per topic (not as permanent members), so issues are covered strategically, tactically, and operationally (p. 214).

Jager's commentary (author's view): All-C-level boards he has seen were "too-strategic", leaving implementation teams without the information they need (pp. 214-215).

8.3.5 How to Set Up an Architecture Board (pp. 215-224)

Step	Key activities	Page
1. Define purpose and scope	Objectives; scope (domains, decision types, level of operation); governance principles	pp. 216-217
2. Identify key stakeholders	Business stakeholders, Enterprise and Segment Architects, security and compliance, IT leaders, project managers; define roles (chair, secretary, decision-makers)	p. 217
3. Develop the operating model	Meeting cadence; standard agenda; decision-making (consensus, majority voting, escalation)	p. 218
4. Define engagement model and workflows	Submission process and templates; review criteria; feedback loop; decision documentation	pp. 218-219
5. Establish key artifacts and tools	Principles and standards; decision templates; collaboration and tracking tools	pp. 220-221
6. Pilot the board	Low-risk pilot project; full cycle; feedback; refine	p. 221
7. Roll out organization-wide	Communicate; onboard projects; monitor metrics; iterate	pp. 221-222
8. Ensure ongoing communication and alignment	Regular updates; cross-board collaboration; continuous education	pp. 222-223
9. Measure and optimize performance	KPIs including business value delivered (often forgotten); feedback loops; continuous improvement	p. 223
10. Celebrate successes and promote value	Publicize achievements; keep communicating business value	pp. 223-224

Jager's commentary (author's view): At a healthcare regulator, the "Architecture Board" was all technicians debating backup designs. He built a new advisory group with management input, which was eventually renamed the Architecture Board, while the old one became the "Architects' Consultation", so nobody lost their forum (pp. 219-220).

8.4 Summary (pp. 224-227)

- Governance controls and manages the architecture and the Architecture Capability, using the Standard's framework as a possible structure, and is implemented in ten steps (pp. 224-225).
- The Architecture Board should be made up of C-level management, key stakeholders, and domain experts, but not exclusively C-level. It needs top-level sponsorship and is set up in ten steps. Keep communicating its business value (pp. 226-227).

Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition	Page
Architecture governance	Streamlining architectural needs into coherent policies, processes, procedures, and standards. Controls and manages the architecture and the Architecture Capability	pp. 189-190
Architecture Governance Framework	TOGAF's reference structure: CIO/CTO, Architecture Board, development/implementation/deployment capabilities, and the repository	pp. 190-192
Architecture Board	Cross-organization, executive-level entity overseeing implementation of the strategy, representative of key stakeholders	p. 205
Governance Charter	Document stating governance scope, objectives, principles, governed areas, and success criteria	p. 194

Term	Definition	Page
RACI matrix	Maps activities to roles as Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed	pp. 196-197
Compliance process	Checklists, lifecycle checkpoints, reviews, and exception handling verifying conformance	pp. 198-199
Segment Architect	The role formerly called Domain Architect	p. 191

Figures & Tables Referenced

Figure / Table	What it shows	Page
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Table 8-1	Example RACI matrix for governance activities	p. 196
Table 8-2	The four RACI responsibilities explained	p. 197
Figure 8-3	Architecture Board led by the CEO	p. 208
Figure 8-4	Ten steps for setting up an Architecture Board	p. 216

Self-Check Questions

Q: What are the three capabilities in TOGAF's Governance Framework, and who directs them?

A: Development (architects), implementation (PMO, vendors, projects), and deployment (service management, operational systems). The CIO/CTO directs them (pp. 191-192).

Q: Why does the word "board" in Architecture Board matter?

A: It refers to the boardroom: issues are strategic, so the board should consist of senior management, key stakeholders, and domain experts, not a group of IT architects (p. 205).

Q: What happens when an Architecture Board is made up only of IT architects?

A: Strategic decisions are made outside the Architecture Capability, which stays reactive and "structurally behind the times" (pp. 205-206).

Q: Contrast CEO-led and CIO/CTO-led architecture in the legislation scenario.

A: CEO-led work is broad and cross-domain (organization, processes, information, applications). CIO-led work covers only information delivery and CTO-led work only the technical side (pp. 206-207).

Q: Name four events that typically trigger the creation of an Architecture Board.

A: A new CIO/CTO; mergers or acquisitions; organizational restructuring; recognition that strategy is not being implemented or is implemented poorly (p. 209).

Q: What size does Jager recommend for an Architecture Board, and how is continuity kept with rotation?

A: Four or five standing members, not more than ten. Fixed terms that end at different times give continuity (pp. 213-214).

Q: Which board responsibilities link to ADM Phases G and H?

A: The control mechanism validating execution against the proposal (usually Phase G), and recognizing divergence from the architecture (Phase H) (pp. 212-213).

Q: List the ten steps for implementing architecture governance.

A: Establish the framework; define roles and responsibilities; develop policies and standards; set up compliance; implement review; establish KPIs; integrate into the ADM; develop a Communications Plan; automate; continuously improve (pp. 194-203).

Q: In RACI, who is Accountable vs. Responsible?

A: Responsible carries out the activity. Accountable is ultimately answerable for its completion, and the responsible person reports to them (p. 197).

Q: Which KPI for the Architecture Board does Jager say is often forgotten?

A: Business value delivered. People get caught up in content and neglect the value proposition (p. 223).

Q: Why does Jager recommend adding lower-level managers and experts to the board on a per-topic basis?

A: All-C-level boards can be too strategic and hand implementation teams too little information. A mix covers strategic, tactical, and operational angles (pp. 214-215).